MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第9回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第9回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To reduce food waste, the hotel buffet switched to smaller serving platters that chefs ( ) frequently with fresh batches.

1 relinquish **2** replenish **3** reprimand **4** resemble

(2) Because the coastal cave floods at high tide, guided tours are strictly ( ) upon the daily lunar tide table.

1 consistent **2** competent **3** complacent **4** contingent

(3) Many commuters remain skeptical that adding one bus per hour will ( ) to ease morning station crowding.

1 suffice **2** subside **3** surpass **4** sustain

(4) The historic clock tower was dismantled piece by piece ( ) repairing its cracked stone foundation.

1 on top of **2** in contrast to **3** with a view to **4** at the expense of

(5) Although both cheeses come from neighboring valleys, their flavors are distinct—one sharp and salty, the other mild and ( ).

1 merry **2** mellow **3** mighty **4** messy

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) When power lines fell across the highway, emergency crews swiftly ( ) southbound traffic onto a parallel river road.

1 devoured **2** devoted **3** diverted **4** devised

(7) Years of patient practice gave the calligrapher remarkable ( ) over brush pressure and ink flow.

1 comfort **2** comment **3** commerce **4** command

(8) Not until the scaffolding came down ( ) townspeople see the vibrant gold leaf restored on the temple roof.

1 could **2** can **3** have **4** were

(9) Because glass laboratory beakers look identical at a glance, students must label every solution clearly lest samples get ( ) up.

1 measured **2** made **3** moved **4** mixed

(10) The botanical garden's night opening proved so popular that tickets sold out within hours of going on ( ).

1 sight **2** sale **3** scale **4** shift

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(11) Far from being ( ), the town's thirty-year-old wooden gymnasium still hosts regional badminton tournaments every winter.

1 obscure **2** obstinate **3** obsolete **4** obedient

(12) All cargo containers entering the port undergo X-ray screening to ( ) undeclared hazardous batteries.

1 detect **2** deflect **3** deduct **4** depict

(13) Although Ms. Hori speaks softly, her calm explanations carry great ( ) during tense budget meetings.

1 width **2** weight **3** wealth **4** warmth

(14) To keep seedlings from freezing, spread straw mulch around the roots once night temperatures dip ( ) below five degrees.

1 consistently **2** courteously **3** casually **4** candidly

(15) The documentary filmmaker spent two autumns in Akita, ( ) earning the trust of elderly basket weavers.

1 gracefully **2** gratefully **3** generously **4** gradually

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) Under no circumstances (　　) visitors feed wild foxes along the mountain road, as human food lures them toward traffic.

1 have　**2** would　**3** should　**4** are

(17) The neighborhood bookstore owes much of its loyal following (　　) monthly reading circles for teens and parents.

1 on　**2** to　**3** with　**4** into

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Escalator Handrails Move Slightly Faster Than the Steps

Anyone who holds onto an escalator handrail during a long subway ride has probably noticed a tiny quirk: after twenty seconds, your hand has crept a couple of centimeters ahead of your body, forcing you to move your fingers back. Commuters often assume the belt is poorly calibrated. In reality, technicians adjust many escalators so the rubber handrail runs roughly one to two percent faster than the metal steps.

Mechanical wear explains part of the design. While the steps are driven by toothed steel chains that never slip, the rubber handrail is pulled over smooth rollers by friction. As rollers age, slight slippage naturally slows the belt down. Setting a new handrail marginally fast ensures it will not lag behind the steps months later. (18), safety researchers point out an important human-balance reason behind that forward bias.

Imagine standing on steep steps rising at thirty degrees if the handrail moved slower than your feet: your arm would gradually get pulled backward, tipping your center of gravity toward the open stairs behind you—the most dangerous direction to fall. A handrail that inches slightly ahead, by contrast, gently nudges posture upright or slightly forward, where knees and ankles can catch a stumble easily. (19), building codes typically allow handrails to run up to two percent faster than steps, while forbidding them to run noticeably slower.

What feels like a minor mechanical mismatch actually reflects (20).

(18)

1 In vain
2 On the contrary
3 Otherwise
4 Beyond mechanics

(19)

1 Accordingly
2 Nevertheless
3 By accident
4 Conversely

(20)

1 an effort to make passengers run up escalators twice as fast
2 a factory defect that technicians cannot repair
3 deliberate engineering aimed at preventing backward falls
4 proof that rubber belts stretch ten meters every week

How Agroforestry Shades Coffee Crops Under Warming Skies

Coffee drinkers rarely picture tall banana palms, nitrogen-fixing acacia trees, and timber hardwoods growing right inside a coffee field. During the late twentieth century, many commercial estates cleared overhead trees so densely planted "sun-grown" coffee bushes, fed with heavy fertilizer, could produce maximum short-term yields.

As tropical dry seasons grow hotter and more erratic, however, full-sun coffee monocultures are showing severe strain. Arabica coffee evolved as an understory shrub in cool Ethiopian cloud forests; exposed to scorching afternoon sun above thirty degrees Celsius, its leaves close their pores, berries ripen too fast, and bean flavor turns flat and bitter. Reintroducing a dappled canopy of shade trees cools leaf temperatures by three to five degrees, letting berries mature slowly into sweeter, denser beans. (21), fallen tree leaves build a thick organic mulch that holds rainwater in the soil weeks longer.

Shade canopies diversify farm income and wildlife habitat simultaneously. While coffee is harvested once a year, fruit, avocados, and sustainably pruned firewood from canopy trees provide food and cash during lean months. Migratory songbirds patrolling the branches devour coffee berry borer beetles, reducing pesticide bills. (22), maximum coffee tonnage per hectare may dip slightly compared with heavily fertilized sun plots, yet lower input costs and specialty-grade bean prices often leave farming families more financially resilient.

Returning trees to coffee hillsides shows how traditional ecological structure can offer (23).

(21)

1 Otherwise
2 Furthermore
3 Instead
4 Conversely

(22)

1 For example
2 Consequently
3 Granted
4 Until then

(23)

1 instant ripening of coffee beans within twenty-four hours
2 a way to harvest Arabica coffee in frozen Arctic tundra
3 higher berry-beetle damage and steeper fertilizer bills
4 practical resilience for both flavor quality and rural livelihoods

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Instructions for Costume Dyeing Workshop Participants

From: Indigo Craft Studio "Aizome-Kobo"
To: Saturday Workshop Participants
Subject: Clothing preparation and fabric limits for natural indigo dyeing

Dear participants,
We are delighted that you will join our natural sukumo indigo dyeing workshop this Saturday from 1:00 p.m. to 4:00 p.m. In addition to the plain cotton tenugui towel included in your fee, each participant may bring ONE personal garment from home to dye in the vats.

Please check the care label of your item carefully tonight: natural plant fibers—100% cotton, linen, or hemp—absorb indigo beautifully, whereas polyester, nylon, and acrylic threads repel natural dye and will remain white, leaving uneven blotches around seams. Even a brand-new 100% cotton T-shirt is coated with invisible factory starch that blocks dye, so you MUST wash your garment in warm water with mild detergent (no fabric softener!) and bring it clean and dry.

Keep the dry weight of your personal item under 250 grams—roughly one adult T-shirt or light tote bag. Heavy denim jeans or thick hoodies soak up too much vat liquid and exhaust the dye bath for others. Long rubber gloves and aprons are provided at the studio.

Warmly,
Aizome-Kobo Team

Instructions for Costume Dyeing Workshop Participants — Questions

(24) What happens if a garment sewn with polyester or nylon thread is dipped into natural indigo?

1 The synthetic threads repel the dye and stay white, creating uneven marks.

2 The entire indigo vat turns bright yellow.

3 Polyester absorbs three times more indigo than linen.

4 The fabric shrinks to the size of a handkerchief.

(25) Why must participants pre-wash even a brand-new 100% cotton T-shirt without fabric softener?

1 To shrink it below 100 grams.

2 To test whether their home washing machine turns blue.

3 Because the studio has no running water.

4 To remove invisible factory starch that blocks the dye from soaking in.

(26) Why are heavy denim jeans and thick hoodies not allowed as the personal item?

1 They are too wide to fit through the studio door.

2 They exceed the 250-gram limit and soak up too much dye bath needed for other participants.

3 Only tenugui towels exist in blue.

4 Rubber gloves tear when touching denim.

How Quiet Asphalt Reduces Highway Tire Roar

Stand beside a suburban expressway where cars cruise at eighty kilometers per hour, and you might assume engines and exhaust pipes create most of the noise. For passenger cars built over the past twenty years, however, tire-pavement noise actually overtakes engine sound once speeds pass roughly forty to fifty kilometers per hour—a fact made even clearer as quiet electric vehicles still produce a steady roar at highway speeds.

Much of that highway roar comes from "air pumping." As a spinning rubber tire flattens against smooth, dense asphalt, air trapped inside the tire's tread grooves is squeezed violently and shoots out to the sides like thousands of tiny whistles per second, amplified by the curved horn shape between tire and road. On rain-slicked dense pavement, surface water also sprays upward, reducing driver visibility and increasing hydroplaning risk.

Road engineers in the Netherlands, Japan, and Scandinavia developed an effective acoustic remedy: porous elastic road surfaces, often called "quiet asphalt." By leaving out fine sand particles and binding coarse crushed stone with polymer-modified bitumen, crews lay a top wearing course riddled with interconnected tiny air voids—roughly twenty percent open pore space. Instead of squirting sideways with a hiss, compressed air under the tire escapes harmlessly downward into the porous mat. Rainwater drains straight through those same channels to roadside gutters, cutting splash spray dramatically.

Porous asphalt comes with real upkeep trade-offs, though. Dust, tire rubber crumbs, and autumn mud gradually clog the tiny pores within five to eight years unless specialized high-pressure vacuum trucks flush them clean. In snowy mountain passes, water freezing inside clogged pores can loosen stones under snowplow blades.

Even with shorter resurfacing cycles, cities bordering busy ring roads value porous pavements highly: cutting traffic noise by four to six decibels sounds to the human ear much like cutting traffic volume in half.

How Quiet Asphalt Reduces Highway Tire Roar — Questions

(27) What becomes the dominant source of noise from modern passenger cars above forty to fifty kilometers per hour?

1 Dashboard air-conditioning fans.

2 Engine pistons and exhaust pipes.

3 Interaction between spinning tires and the road surface.

4 Wind whistling through open sunroofs.

(28) How does porous "quiet asphalt" reduce the sound caused by air pumping?

1 Interconnected air voids let compressed air under the tire escape downward instead of shooting out sideways.

2 It melts rubber tires into a smooth liquid layer.

3 It limits highway driving speeds to twenty kilometers per hour.

4 Speakers buried in the road broadcast silence waves.

(29) What safety benefit on rainy days does porous pavement provide in addition to noise reduction?

1 It heats rainwater into warm steam.

2 Rainwater drains through the pores to gutters, sharply reducing surface spray and hydroplaning risk.

3 It paints lane lines bright orange whenever rain starts.

4 It stops electric vehicles from needing windshield wipers.

(30) What maintenance challenges limit porous asphalt over time or in snowy mountain areas?

1 Dirt clogs the pores unless flushed by special trucks, and freezing water plus snowplows can loosen stones.

2 Sunlight turns the coarse stones into fine white sand within a month.

3 Polymer bitumen attracts wild deer onto expressways.

4 Porous roads cannot support vehicles heavier than bicycles.

How Quiet Asphalt Reduces Highway Tire Roar — Questions (continued)

(31) How significant is a four-to-six-decibel noise reduction to nearby residents according to the final paragraph?

1 It is completely undetectable to human ears.

2 It eliminates all road sound within five kilometers.

3 It makes electric cars sound louder than trucks.

4 It sounds roughly equivalent to cutting traffic volume in half.